

RAM & ROM

8.1 Lesson 2 · Do Now · Objectives

Name: _____ Class: _____

DO NOW · 5 MINUTES

1. What type of software was ALICE?

2. Classify a keyboard: input, storage or output?

3. Classify a hard drive: input, storage or output?

4. Classify a speaker: input, storage or output?

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1 Identify the key features of RAM and ROM and their role in the computer system.
- 2 Explain the difference between the purpose of RAM and ROM.
- 3 Explain what reading and writing from memory means and how it is used.

KEY TERMS

Random Access Memory · Read Only Memory · Volatile · Read from / Write to

Key Knowledge

RAM · ROM · volatility · read/write

RAM

Random Access Memory stores the data and programs that you are currently running.

RAM is used to hold:

- The Operating System
- Open Documents
- Running Programs

Source table: RAM is volatile; data is wiped when it loses power; RAM is read & write.

ROM

Read Only Memory stores a program which takes the computer through all the steps to start up the computer.

Source table: ROM is non-volatile; data is not lost; ROM is read only.

FLASHBACK

RAM and ROM are types of memory. The lesson states that the CPU fetches instructions directly from them.

QUICK RETRIEVAL

Which stores open documents and running programs?

Which stores a start-up program?

Which is volatile?

Which is read only?

Compare RAM & ROM

Class Notebook task

COPY AND COMPLETE THIS TABLE

The original lesson asks you to complete this comparison in your Class Notebook.

	ROM	RAM
Why is it needed? What does it store?		
Volatile or Non-Volatile?		
Write / Read?		

WHY USE A TABLE?

The source lesson says a table makes information easy to read and organised, shows a lot of information in a small area, and helps quickly compare similarities and differences.

Challenge & Exit

Read from · Write to · Reflection

CHALLENGE

Below your table, explain what reading and writing from memory means and how it is used.

Consider:

- What data might we want to change?
- Will reading change the data?
- What happens when you write to something?
- What could go wrong?

MY EXPLANATION

EXIT REFLECTION

Tick one: ☐ Ready ☐ Nearly there ☐ Need help

One difference between RAM and ROM:

One thing I still need help with:
